Louis Schiekiera

Researcher, Computational Modeling Lab, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin · PhD candidate, Freie Universität Berlin

louis.schiekiera@hu-berlin.de · schiekiera.github.io · ORCID 0000-0003-0082-175X · github.com/schiekiera

EXPERIENCE

2024 - now
Research Assistant
Computational Modeling Group, Institute for Psychology, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin

2023 - 2024
Research Assistant
Division of Clinical Psychological Intervention, Freie Universität Berlin

2021 - 2023
Student Research Assistant
Division of Clinical Psychological Intervention, Freie Universität Berlin

2018 - 2021
Student Research Assistant
Institute for Medical Psychology and Institute for Medical Sociology, University Medical Center Hamburg-Eppendorf

2018 - 2019
Student Research Assistant
Department of General Sociology and Theory of Modern Societies, Technical University of Berlin

EDUCATION

2024 - now
PhD Psychology
Freie Universität Berlin, Berlin, Germany
Thesis: Understanding Publication Bias Using Large Language Models and Behavioral Methods
Advisors: Dr. Helen Niemeyer & Prof. Christine Knaevelsrud

2021 - 2023
MSc Psychology
University of Potsdam, Potsdam, Germany
Thesis: Abstract Classification for Publication Bias Research in Clinical Psychology Using Natural Language Processing
Advisors: Dr. Helen Niemeyer & Dr. Jochen Laubrock

2018 - 2021
BSc Psychology
University of Hamburg, Hamburg, Germany
Thesis: Parental Quality of Life After the Child's Intensive Therapy: A Longitudinal Study on Parents of Pediatric Cancer Patients
Advisors: Prof. Jenny Wagner & Prof. Laura Inhestern

2014 - 2018
BA Sociology and Technology Studies
Technical University of Berlin, Berlin, Germany
Thesis: Medicalization of homelessness? On the discursive construction of the connection between traumatic brain injury and homelessness
Advisors: Dr. René Tuma & Prof. Jan-Peter Voß
Minor: Human Factors Engineering

PUBLICATIONS

2026
A Computational Swinging Lexical Network: Cohort Concentration Predicts Semantic Interference in a Large-Scale Picture–Word Interference Dataset
Louis Schiekiera, Rasha Abdel Rahman, Alissa Melinger, Vincent Gruber, and Fritz Günther
PsyArXiv preprint · PDF

2026 **LinearPFN: Amortized Variable Selection for Linear Models with Interactions**
Louis Schiekiera, Max Zimmer, Christophe Roux, Manuel Arnold, Sebastian Pokutta, and Fritz Günther
arXiv preprint · PDF

2026 **Post-training makes large language models less human-like**
Marcel Binz, Elif Akata, Abdullah Almaatouq, and 77 more (including Louis Schiekiera)
arXiv preprint · PDF

2026 **A harmonized trial-level dataset of picture-word interference**
Louis Schiekiera, Rasha Abdel Rahman, Vincent Gruber, Audrey Bürki, Antje Lorenz, Kirsten Stark, and Fritz Günther
PsyArXiv preprint · PDF

2026 **From Associations to Activations: Comparing Behavioral and Hidden-State Semantic Geometry in LLMs**
Louis Schiekiera, Max Zimmer, Christophe Roux, Sebastian Pokutta, and Fritz Günther
Proceedings of the 43rd International Conference on Machine Learning · PDF

2025 **Publication Bias in Academic Decision-Making in Clinical Psychology**
Louis Schiekiera, Kristina Eichel, Felicitas Hesselmann, Jacqueline Sachse, Sophie Müller, and Helen Niemeyer
Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science · PDF

2025 **Does Scientific Productivity Increase the Publication of Positive Results?**
Louis Schiekiera and Helen Niemeyer
Collabra: Psychology · PDF

2025 **Political bias in historiography - an experimental investigation of preferences for publication as a function of political orientation**
Louis Schiekiera and Helen Niemeyer
F1000Research · PDF

2024 **Classifying Positive Results in Clinical Psychology Using Natural Language Processing**
Louis Schiekiera, Helen Niemeyer, and Jonathan Diederichs
Zeitschrift für Psychologie · PDF

2024 **How inclusive and equitable is research in clinical psychology that focuses on the Global South?**
Helen Niemeyer and Louis Schiekiera
A Better How: Notes on Developmental Meta-Research · PDF

2021 **Fear of progression in parents of childhood cancer survivors: prevalence and associated factors**
Mona L Peikert, Laura Inhestern, Konstantin A Krauth, Gabriele Escherich, Stefan Rutkowski, Daniela Kandels, Louis Schiekiera, and Corinna Bergelt
Journal of cancer survivorship · PDF

TALKS

Sep 2026 **Research Agents in Cognitive Science: A Case Study**
ZIB Connect (Retreat on Agentic AI in Research), Speinshart Scientific Center for AI and SuperTech, Speinshart, DE

Jul 2026 **What Drives Interference? A Mega-Analytic Approach to Predicting Reaction Times from Word Properties**
WoProc 2026, Lisbon, PT · presented by Kirsten Stark · Slides

Jul 2026 **The German Lexicon Project**
WoProc 2026, Lisbon, PT · presented by Aliona Petrenco · Slides

May 2026 **Aligning Behavioral and Hidden-State Semantic Geometry in LLMs**
Behavioral Clones Workshop 2026, Berlin, DE · Slides

Mar 2026 — **The TRUST Guidelines for Psycholinguistic Reading Studies and the German Lexicon Project**
TEAP 2026, Tübingen, DE · presented by Jana Hasenäcker · Slides

Mar 2026 — **Beyond Lemmas: Modeling the Picture in Picture-Word Interference?**
TEAP 2026, Tübingen, DE · Slides

Mar 2026 — **Symposium: Computational Modeling of Language Generation (co-chaired with Hanna Wołoszyn, Cologne)**
TEAP 2026 (Symposium Chair), Tübingen, DE · Slides

Mar 2026 — **Data Collection Process for the German Lexicon Project**
TRUST Network Meeting, Cologne, DE · Slides

Feb 2026 — **LLMs as Agents in Psycholinguistic Research**
Research Colloquium 'Methods', HU Berlin, Berlin, DE · Slides

Apr 2025 — **Publication Bias in Psychology: Positive Results and Scientific Productivity of Research Groups**
4. Deutscher Psychotherapie Kongress (DPK 2025), Berlin, DE · Slides

Mar 2023 — **Publication Bias in Academic Publishing: Researchers' Accounts of Publication Decisions**
STS-hub.de 2023 Circulations, RWTH Aachen, DE · presented by Jacqueline Sachse · Slides

POSTERS

Jul 2026 — **From Associations to Activations: Comparing Behavioral and Hidden-State Semantic Geometry in LLMs**
ICML 2026, Seoul, KR · Poster

Apr 2026 — **Transparent, Transferable, and Sustainable Foundation for Psycholinguistic Reading Studies in German, the TRUST Guidelines, and the German Lexicon Project (GLP)**
16. Tagung der Österreichischen Gesellschaft für Psychologie (ÖGP 2026), Salzburg, AT · presented by Benjaming Gagl · Poster

Mar 2026 — **Automated Validation of Verbal Responses in Language-Production Research**
TEAP 2026, Tübingen, DE · presented by Vincent Gruber · Poster

Nov 2025 — **Climate Change and Health Sector Planning: A Mixed-Methods Analysis of National Health Strategies**
18th European Public Health Conference (EPH 2025), Helsinki, FI · presented by Mirna Al Masri · Poster

Oct 2025 — **Climate Change and Health Sector Planning: A Mixed-Methods Analysis of National Health Strategies**
2025 Planetary Health Annual Meeting, Rotterdam, NL · presented by Mirna Al Masri · Poster

Sep 2025 — **Modeling Lexical Competition in Language Production: A Computational Approach to the Swinging Lexical Network**
ESCOP 2025, Sheffield, UK · Poster

TEACHING

Fall 26 — **Your personal AI research assistant: Using Large Language Models and chatbots in applied research** (Workshop, co-taught with Fritz Günther)
Universität Tübingen, Tübingen, DE · 5th Fall School of the Methods Center: Advanced AI for Research Design and Analysis

SoSe 26 — **Understanding Representations Using Language Statistics** (Guest lecture)
Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Berlin, DE · Unfinished Business: Open Questions Across Mind, Brain, and Behavior

SoSe 25 **Metaphors in Large Language Models** (Guest lecture)
Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Berlin, DE · Large Language Models and Human Cognition

WiSe 25/26 **Reproducibility in Clinical Psychology Research** (Guest lecture)
Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Berlin, DE · Clinical Implications of Open Science and Reproducibility: Confronting Psychology's Credibility Crisis

WiSe 25/26 **Introduction to Statistics I** (Seminar)
Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Berlin, DE